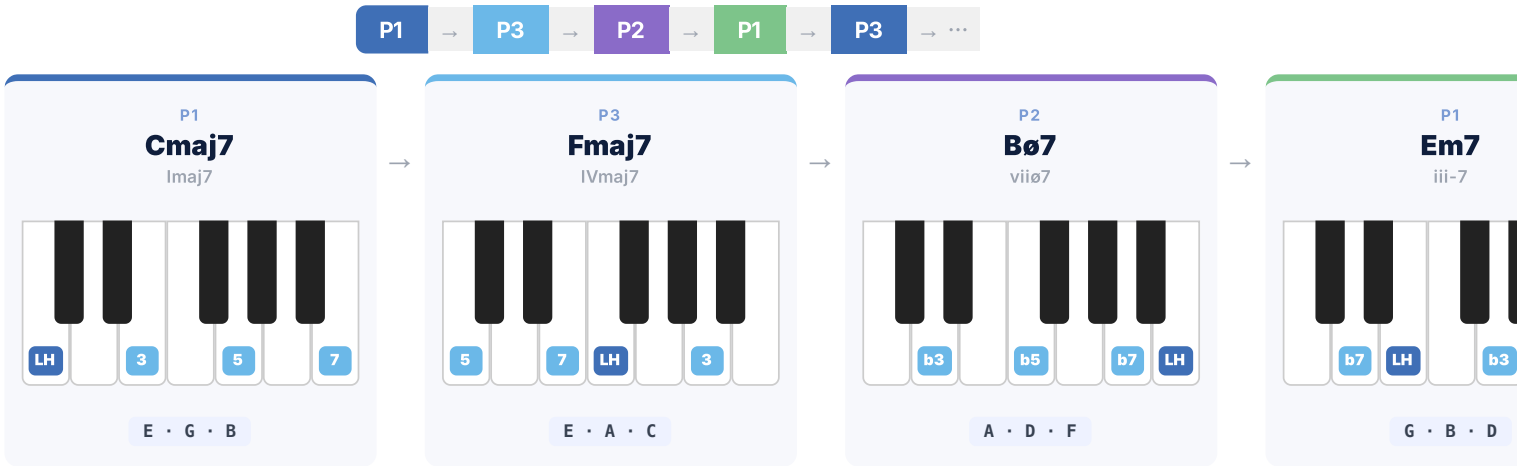


POSITION THEORY — VOICE LEADING THE CYCLE

Four consecutive chords from Cycle 5 — each in its correct position, with smooth voice movement between them.

P3 → P2 → P1 → P3 THROUGH CYCLE 5



VOICE MOVEMENT ANALYSIS — EACH TRANSITION

Transition	Top Voice	Middle Voice	Bottom Voice (RH)	Movement Quality
Cmaj7 → Fmaj7	B → C (+1)	G → A (+2)	E → E (stays)	Step or common tone ✓
Fmaj7 → Bø7	C → D (+2)	A → A (stays)	E → F (+1)	Step or common tone ✓
Bø7 → Em7	F → G (+2)	D → D (stays)	A → B (+2)	Step or common tone ✓

WHY THIS WORKS

When roots move in 4ths, **adjacent positions minimize voice movement** — notes travel by step (1-2 semitones) or stay put as common tones. This happens because the 7th of one chord is often the 3rd of the next chord in Cycle 5. Position theory makes this automatic: you don't analyze voice leading, you just follow the **P3 → P2 → P1 → P3** pattern and smooth motion emerges.